ADRA

A practical guide to the United Nations

ADRA' United Nations Advisory Group
4-1-2026

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What is the ADRA UN Liaison Office

The ADRA United Nations Liaison Office is the organization's bridge to the UN system, ensuring ADRA's humanitarian voice is represented in global policy spaces while strengthening partnerships with UN agencies, funds, and programs. Its core functions include:

1. **Representation & Advocacy:** Positions ADRA as a credible humanitarian actor in UN forums, influencing policy on a wide range of issues that ADRA is dealing with at country level.
2. **Relationship Building:** Maintains direct links with agencies such as but not limited to UNICEF, UNHCR, WFP, UNDP, WHO, and UN Women, facilitating programmatic and procurement partnerships through portals like UNPP and UNGM.
3. **Information Flow & Coordination:** Channels UN policy developments, funding opportunities, and thematic priorities back to ADRA's regional and country offices, enhancing alignment with the UN Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (UNSDCF).

Strategic Value of the UN Liaison Office

Visibility & Legitimacy: Elevates ADRA's profile as a trusted partner for governments, donors, and UN agencies.

Policy Influence: Amplifies grassroots experiences into global advocacy, shaping debates on the various thematic areas of ADRA's engagement.

Operational Leverage: Unlocks access to UN funding streams, technical expertise, and global standards, strengthening ADRA's impact and sustainability.

ADRA's Comparative Advantage

ADRA's unique strength in the UN systems is the ability to bridge global humanitarian priorities with local community realities. With a strong grassroots presence through national offices, ADRA can reach vulnerable populations quickly and effectively. Its faith-based identity fosters trust and credibility at the community level, while its professional humanitarian standards ensure alignment with UN principles. ADRA's integrated approach combining relief, development, and advocacy mirrors the UN's humanitarian–development–peace nexus, making it a natural partner. Furthermore, its history of collaboration with UN agencies like WFP, UNICEF, and UNHCR demonstrates its capacity to complement large-scale operations by filling gaps at the community level. Finally, ADRA's flexibility and efficiency allows it to mobilize resources rapidly and adapt to local contexts, reinforcing its role as a valuable partner in advancing UN goals.

Part I: UN Systems Overview

The United Nations system is anchored in six principal organs which provide governance, peace and security, economic and social coordination, judicial authority and administrative capacity. These principal organs include i) General Assembly, ii) Security Council , iii) Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC), iv) Trusteeship Council v) International Court of Justice, vi) Secretariat.

The UN system further includes other organs that are classified as funds and programs which are subsidiary bodies created by the General Assembly or ECOSOC. For further details refer to ADRA Network UN Policies, Guidelines and Took Kit.

The United Nations System

Building Our Future Together

PRINCIPAL ORGANS

GENERAL ASSEMBLY

SUBSIDIARY ORGANS

Intergovernmental and Expert Bodies

- Disarmament Commission
- Human Rights Council
- International Law Commission
- Joint Inspection Unit (JIU)
- United Nations Commission on International Trade Law
- Main Committees
- Standing committees and ad hoc bodies

Funds and Programmes[1]

UNDP United Nations Development Programme
- **UNCDF** United Nations Capital Development Fund
- **UNV** United Nations Volunteers

UNEP[6] United Nations Environment Programme
UNFPA United Nations Population Fund
UN-HABITAT[6] United Nations Human Settlements Programme
UNICEF United Nations Children's Fund
WFP World Food Programme (UN/FAO)

Research and Training

UNIDIR United Nations Institute for Disarmament Research
UNITAR United Nations Institute for Training and Research
UNSSC United Nations System Staff College
UNU United Nations University

Other Entities

ITC International Trade Centre (UN/WTO)
UNCTAD[1,6] United Nations Conference on Trade and Development
UNHCR[1] Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees
UNOPS[1] United Nations Office for Project Services
UNRWA[1] United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East
UN-WOMEN[1] United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women

SECURITY COUNCIL

SUBSIDIARY ORGANS

- Counter-Terrorism Committee
- International Residual Mechanism for Criminal Tribunals
- Military Staff Committee
- Peacekeeping operations and special political missions
- Standing committees and ad hoc bodies
- Sanctions Committees

ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL COUNCIL

COMMISSIONS AND OTHER SUBSIDIARY ORGANS

Functional Commissions

- Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice
- Narcotic Drugs
- Population and Development
- Science and Technology for Development
- Social Development
- Statistics
- Status of Women
- United Nations Forum on Forests

Regional Commissions[6]

ECA Economic Commission for Africa
ECE Economic Commission for Europe
ECLAC Economic Commission for Latin America and the Caribbean
ESCAP Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific
ESCWA Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia

Other Bodies[8]

- Committee for Development Policy
- Committee of Experts on Public Administration
- Committee on Non-Governmental Organizations
- Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues

UNAIDS Joint United Nations Programme on HIV/AIDS
UNGEGN United Nations Group of Experts on Geographical Names
UNGGIM Committee of Experts on Global Geospatial Information Management

Research and Training

UNICRI United Nations Interregional Crime and Justice Research Institute
UNRISD United Nations Research Institute for Social Development

SECRETARIAT

DEPARTMENTS AND OFFICES[7]

EOSG Executive Office of the Secretary-General
DCO Development Coordination Office
DESA Department of Economic and Social Affairs
DGACM Department for General Assembly and Conference Management
DGC Department of Global Communications
DMSPC Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
DOS Department of Operational Support
DPO Department of Peace Operations
DPPA Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs
DSS Department of Safety and Security
OCHA Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
OCT Office of Counter-Terrorism
ODA Office for Disarmament Affairs
ODET Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies
OHCHR Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights
OIOS Office of Internal Oversight Services
OLA Office of Legal Affairs
OOSA Office for Outer Space Affairs
OSAA Office of the Special Adviser on Africa
SRSG/CAAC Office of the Special Representative of the Secretary-General for Children and Armed Conflict
SRSG/SVC Office of the Special Representative of the Secretary-General on Sexual Violence in Conflict
SRSG/VAC Office of the Special Representative of the Secretary-General on Violence Against Children
UNDRR United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction
UNODC[1] United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime
UNOG United Nations Office at Geneva
UN-OHRLLS Office of the High Representative for the Least Developed Countries, Landlocked Developing Countries and Small Island Developing States
UNON United Nations Office at Nairobi
UNOP[2] United Nations Office for Partnerships
UNOV United Nations Office at Vienna
UN YOUTH United Nations Youth Office

INTERNATIONAL COURT OF JUSTICE

TRUSTEESHIP COUNCIL[4]

RELATED ORGANIZATIONS[3]

CTBTO Preparatory Commission Preparatory Commission for the Comprehensive Nuclear-Test-Ban Treaty Organization
IAEA[3] International Atomic Energy Agency
ICC International Criminal Court
IOM[1] International Organization for Migration
ISA International Seabed Authority
ITLOS International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea
OPCW Organization for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons
WTO[1] World Trade Organization

Peacebuilding Commission

HLPF[9] High-level Political Forum on Sustainable Development

SPECIALIZED AGENCIES[1,3]

FAO Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
ICAO International Civil Aviation Organization
IFAD International Fund for Agricultural Development
ILO International Labour Organization
IMF International Monetary Fund
IMO International Maritime Organization
ITU International Telecommunication Union
UNESCO United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
UNIDO United Nations Industrial Development Organization
UN TOURISM World Tourism Organization
UPU Universal Postal Union
WHO World Health Organization
WIPO World Intellectual Property Organization
WMO World Meteorological Organization
WORLD BANK GROUP[5]
- **IBRD** International Bank for Reconstruction and Development
- **IDA** International Development Association
- **IFC** International Finance Corporation

Notes:

1 Member of the United Nations System Chief Executives Board for Coordination (CEB).
2 The United Nations Office for Partnerships is the focal point vis-a-vis the United Nations Foundation, Inc.
3 These organizations are separate and independent from the United Nations. They have been brought into relationship with the United Nations through relationship agreements.
4 The Trusteeship Council suspended operations on 1 November 1994, as Palau, the last United Nations Trust Territory, became independent on 1 October 1994.
5 International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID) and Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) are not specialized agencies in accordance with Articles 57 and 63 of the Charter, but are part of the World Bank Group.
6 The secretariats of these organs are part of the United Nations Secretariat.
7 The Secretariat also includes the following offices: the Ethics Office, United Nations Ombudsman and Mediation Services, and the Office of Administration of Justice.
8 For a complete list of ECOSOC subsidiary organs see un.org/ecosoc.
9 HLPF was established by the General Assembly. Meetings of HLPF are separately convened under the auspices of the General Assembly and of the Economic and Social Council.

This Chart is intended to provide a graphical reflection of the functional organization of the United Nations system and is for informational purposes only. The relevant rules of the organization concerned should be consulted in order to establish the legal status, functions and reporting lines of each entity shown in this Chart. The Chart does not include all offices or entities of the United Nations system.

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At country level the UN system works through the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (UNSDCF) which brings together the various UN agencies classified as either funds and programs, specialized agencies or related organizations to respond to the country's specific needs.

Each ADRA country office is encouraged to align its programs to its respective National Development Framework which further allows ADRA to align with National priorities as well as the UNSDCF country specific priorities which are funded. Through such alignment, ADRA is seen as a credible partner both to government and the UN system.

Funds and Programmes

These are subsidiary organs of the United Nations (established by resolutions of the General Assembly or ECOSOC). While they are part of the UN structure, they are administered separately. The Funds and Programs are not independent legal entities and operate under the UN's umbrella and do not have separate international legal personality (though some function with a high degree of autonomy in practice).

These entities report to the General Assembly and/or ECOSOC; governed by executive boards or similar bodies with member state representation (often including donors and recipient countries). The funds and programs were established by the General Assembly or ECOSOC to deliver specific technical assistance, humanitarian aid, development projects, and on-the-ground activities in focused areas such as poverty reduction, children, population, environment. The funds and programs ADRA would typically work with include

- **UNDP:** United Nations Development Programme – Focuses on poverty eradication, reduction of inequalities, and building resilience to crises.
- **UNEP:** United Nations Environment Programme – Acts as the global authority that sets the environmental agenda and promotes sustainable development.
- **UNFPA:** United Nations Population Fund – Focuses on reproductive health, family planning, and maternal health.
- **UN-Habitat:** United Nations Human Settlements Programme – Promotes socially and environmentally sustainable towns and cities.
- **UNICEF:** United Nations Children's Fund – Provides long-term humanitarian and developmental assistance to children and mothers.
- **WFP:** World Food Programme – The world's largest humanitarian agency addressing hunger and promoting food security
- **UN-WOMEN:** UN Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women – Focuses on gender equality and female empowerment.
- **UNCTAD:** UN Conference on Trade and Development – Deals with trade, investment, and development issues

Specialized Agencies

The specialized agencies are autonomous, independent international organizations linked to the UN through formal agreements (as provided in the UN Charter, Articles 57 and 63). These agencies are fully independent legal entities with their own constitutions, international treaties, membership

(which often overlap but are not identical to UN membership), and have separate juridical personality.

Unlike the funds and programs which are governed by the General Assembly, the specialized agencies have their own legislative bodies often referred to as general conferences or assemblies, they have separate executive councils, and secretariats and coordinate with the UN via ECOSOC and the Chief Executives Board for Coordination.

The specialized agencies offer sectoral and normative/technical support setting global standards, provide expertise, conduct research, and promote cooperation in specific fields like health, labor, education, agriculture, aviation, etc. Beyond delivery of projects these guide and develop policy. Listed here are some of the specialized agencies ADRA would typically work with.

- **FAO:** Food and Agriculture Organization – Works to end hunger globally.
- **IFAD:** International Fund for Agricultural Development – Targets rural poverty in developing nations.
- **ILO:** International Labour Organization – Promotes workers' rights and employment opportunities.
- **UNESCO:** UN Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization – Fosters international cooperation through education, science, and culture.
- **WHO:** World Health Organization – The leading authority on international health within the UN system.

Related Organizations

The other bodies or related organizations vary widely in structure and relationship to the UN where some are subsidiary UN bodies while others are independent or related via agreements. These organizations focus on a wide range of areas including humanitarian/refugee-focused offices, research/training institutes, coordination bodies, or affiliated organizations addressing niche or emerging issues.

ADRA engagement is typical but not limited to the following related organizations

- **IOM:** International Organization for Migration – The leading intergovernmental organization in the field of migration, which formally joined the UN system as a related organization in September 2016.
- **UNOPS:** United Nations Office for Project Services operates using a fee for service model with no global policy mandate or development programming approach but instead provides operational services to other partners. It acts as a central resource for the UN system, implementing projects on behalf or other UN entities, governments and international financial institutions.
- **UNAIDS:** Is a joint programme on HIV/AIDS with a mandate to lead, strengthen and support an expanded multisectoral response to HIV and AIDS.
- **UNFCC:** the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change Secretariate which supports international climate negotiations and implementation
- **UNDRR:** the United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction coordinates global efforts to reduce disaster risks.
- **UNRWA:** UN Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees – Provides services specifically to Palestine refugees.

- **UNHCR:** United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees – Protects and supports refugees and displaced persons.

Note that the classification of these entities changes and with new resolutions or integrations from emerging or specialized global challenges.

Part II: Partnership Strategies for ADRA at the Global Level

While UN agencies have specific mandates, there are areas of overlaps or wider scope of operations in varied country contexts. Having an understanding of which agency does what can offer ADRA insights in establishing partnerships.

The list below considers that UN entities that ADRA typically works with and their focus area.

UN Entity	Area of Interest	Specific Focus	Convergence with ADRA
UNICEF	Child rights, education, health	Primary education, child protection, immunization	Strong overlap with ADRA's Education and Health programs
UNDP	Development, governance, livelihoods	Poverty reduction, democratic governance, resilience	Converges with ADRA's Livelihoods and governance/consortium-building
WFP	Food security, nutrition	Emergency food aid, school feeding, resilience building	Direct synergy with ADRA's Emergency and Livelihoods
UNHCR	Refugees, statelessness, protection	Legal identity, resettlement, camp management	Aligns with ADRA's work in refugee education, livelihoods, and legal identity
UNFPA	Population, reproductive health	Maternal health, gender equality, youth empowerment	Converges with ADRA's Health and child protection
WHO	Global health	Disease prevention, health systems strengthening	Strong overlap with ADRA's Health programs
FAO	Agriculture, food systems	Rural livelihoods, sustainable farming	Converges with ADRA's Livelihoods and climate-health risk mitigation
ILO	Labor rights, employment	Decent work, migrant worker protections	Direct synergy with ADRA's Livelihoods and refugee/migrant worker outreach

UNESCO	Education, culture, science	Literacy, vocational training, cultural heritage	Overlaps with ADRA's Education and community empowerment
UN Women	Gender equality	Women's empowerment, protection from violence	Converges with ADRA's Livelihoods and child protection
UNEP	Environment, sustainability	Climate action, pollution control	Aligns with ADRA's interest in environmental health and climate-health risk mitigation
OCHA	Humanitarian coordination	Emergency response, disaster preparedness	Direct synergy with ADRA's Emergency relief and coordination role

Mapping of ADRA's impact areas with the UN structure

As a faith-based organization ADRA has access to hard to reach and trust-based communities across the global making ADRA an effective local partner working with standards expected of an international organisation. This presence allows for last mile delivery capacity. The multi sector expertise enables effective integrated programming

1. Health

Shared objective: Improving access to health and nutrition, clean water and disease prevention
UN Agencies: WHO, UNICEF, UNFPA, WFP,
Strategic positioning

- Position as an implementing partner for last mile service delivery especially in hard to reach and fragile contexts
- Integrate health, nutrition and WASH programming with the UN multisectoral approaches
- Engage in pooled funding mechanism (eg Global Fund, Gavi-supported platforms)
- Leverage health capacities in country using the Adventist health service to complement capacity and contribute and strengthen community health workforce.

2. Education

Shared objective: Offering opportunity for inclusive, equitable education and lifelong learning.
UN Agencies: UNICEF, UNESCO, UNHCR
Strategi positioning

- Position as a bridge actor between humanitarian education and formal education systems

- Lead in community based and non formal education modules particularly in displacement settings through skills and vocational training to offer non formal and alternative learning pathways
- Showcase proven scalable modes for accelerated education and skills-based learning
- Partner with UNHCR/UNICEF on Education Cannot Wait programming
- Collaborate with Adventists Education services to offer accredited education pathways

3. Livelihoods

Shared objective: Ending poverty through employment, food security and economic inclusion
UN Agencies: UNDP, ILO, FAO, WFP, UNHCR
Strategic positioning

- Position as an operational partner translating policy into livelihood outcomes particularly in fragile and displacement contexts
- Lead on displaced person and marginalised community economic inclusion models aligned with national labour frameworks
- Co-design and lead livelihood programmes
- Private sector partnership engagement to integrate skills recognition job placement and entrepreneurship support

4. Emergency

Shared objective: Emergency response and disaster risk reduction, climate resilience
UN Agencies: IOM, WFP, OCHA, UNHCR
Strategic positioning

- Engage in clusters and coordination mechanisms
- Demonstrate how ADRA has broad based volunteers with strong community access enabling quick response time in emergencies.
- Define localization and nexus programming from ADRA's perspective
- Demonstrate capacity in anticipatory action and climate resilience
- Demonstrate ADRAs capacity through the NEMP aligning emergency programming with Humanitarian Response Plans and Flash appeals.

5. Crosscutting Areas

ADRA can:

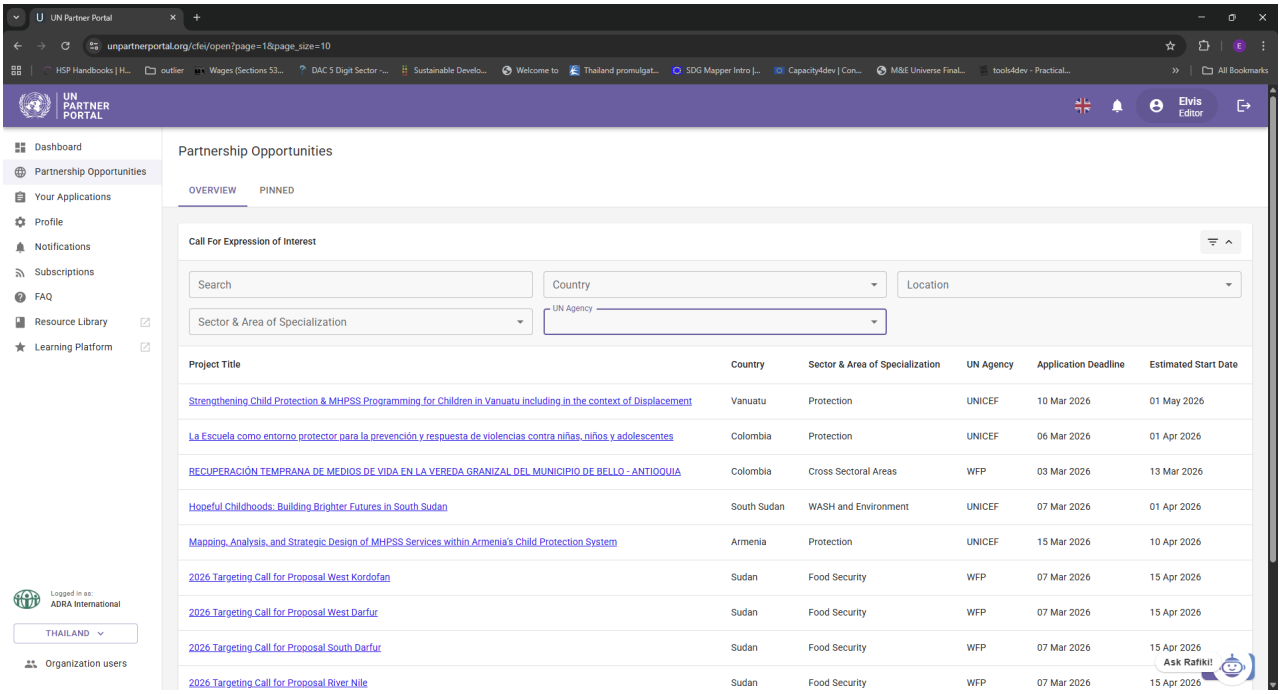
- Advocate for refugees and marginalized community vulnerabilities in relation to a wide range of areas including climate change and environmental health
- Collaborate on migrant and refugee protection, livelihoods support and development, coordination of humanitarian assistance, advocacy.
- Demonstrate community led accountability models focusing on PSEAH and accountability to affected populations.
- Embed gender sensitive programming across all impact areas

Engaging with the UN

ADRA has standing frameworks and guidelines on working with the UN System through various partnership mechanisms.

The UN Partner Portal

The UN offers a centralized online platform for NGOs, civil society organizations and academic institutions to establish programmatic partnerships with UN Agencies. It was created to streamline collaboration and make partnership processes more transparent and accessible. It offers **Single Registration** meaning organizations register once and can then be considered by multiple UN agencies (e.g., UNICEF, UNHCR, WFP, UNFPA, UN Women, UNOPS, IOM). UN Agencies post calls for proposals and partnership opportunities directly on the portal allowing NGOs to engage in the partnership process. The portal standardizes vetting, requiring NGOs to upload governance documents, audited financials, and organizational profiles once which then eliminates the need to go through a similar process for each UN Agency to which you apply. Registered organizations receive alerts about new opportunities relevant to their sector or region while opportunities for capacity building are provided through the portal through training modules and guidance to help NGOs meet UN standards for accountability and program delivery.



https://www.unpartnerportal.org

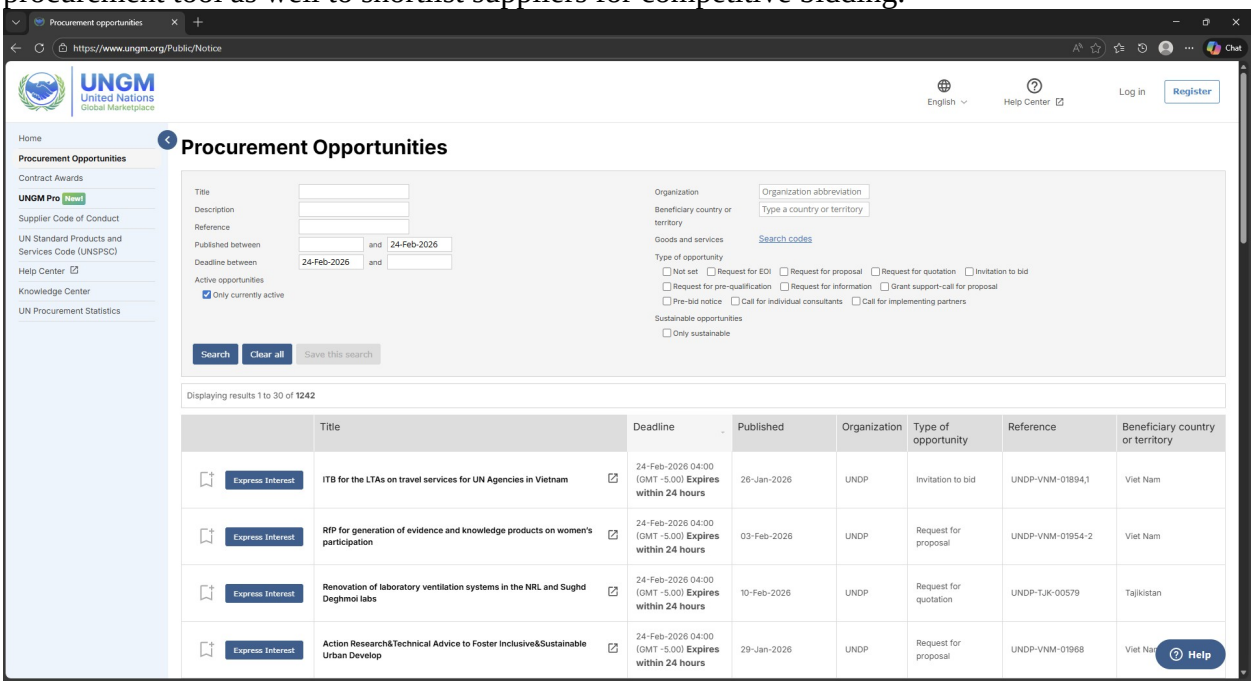
The United Nations Global Marketplace (**UNGM)**

The UNGM is the procurement portal of the UN System. It brings together UN procurement staff and the supplier community. The United Nations represents a global market of over USD 14 billion annually for all types of goods and services.

The UNGM acts as a single window, through which potential suppliers may register with the 20 UN Agencies using the UNGM as their supplier roster. These agencies account for 95% of the total UN procurement spent, the UNGM therefore provides an excellent springboard to introduce your

goods and services to many UN organizations, countries and regions by only completing one registration form.

The UNGM also enables suppliers to keep abreast of upcoming tender notices and by now subscribing to the tender alert service to receive relevant business opportunities directly in their e-mail. Further the UNGM facilitates the interchange of supplier information within the UN system as information is made available to all UN organizations. The UNGM acts as an important procurement tool as well to shortlist suppliers for competitive bidding.



https://www.ungm.org/

ADRA - UN Partnership Roadmap

Step 1: Register on Core UN Portals

- UN Partner Portal (UNPP) → For programmatic partnerships with UNICEF, UNHCR, WFP, UNFPA, UN Women, UNOPS, IOM, etc.
- UN Global Marketplace (UNGM) → For procurement opportunities across 20+ UN agencies.

Step 2: Leverage ADRA's ECOSOC status

- Participate in UN deliberations, submit statements, and attend official meetings.
- Join thematic civil society advisory groups (e.g., UN Women CSAGs).

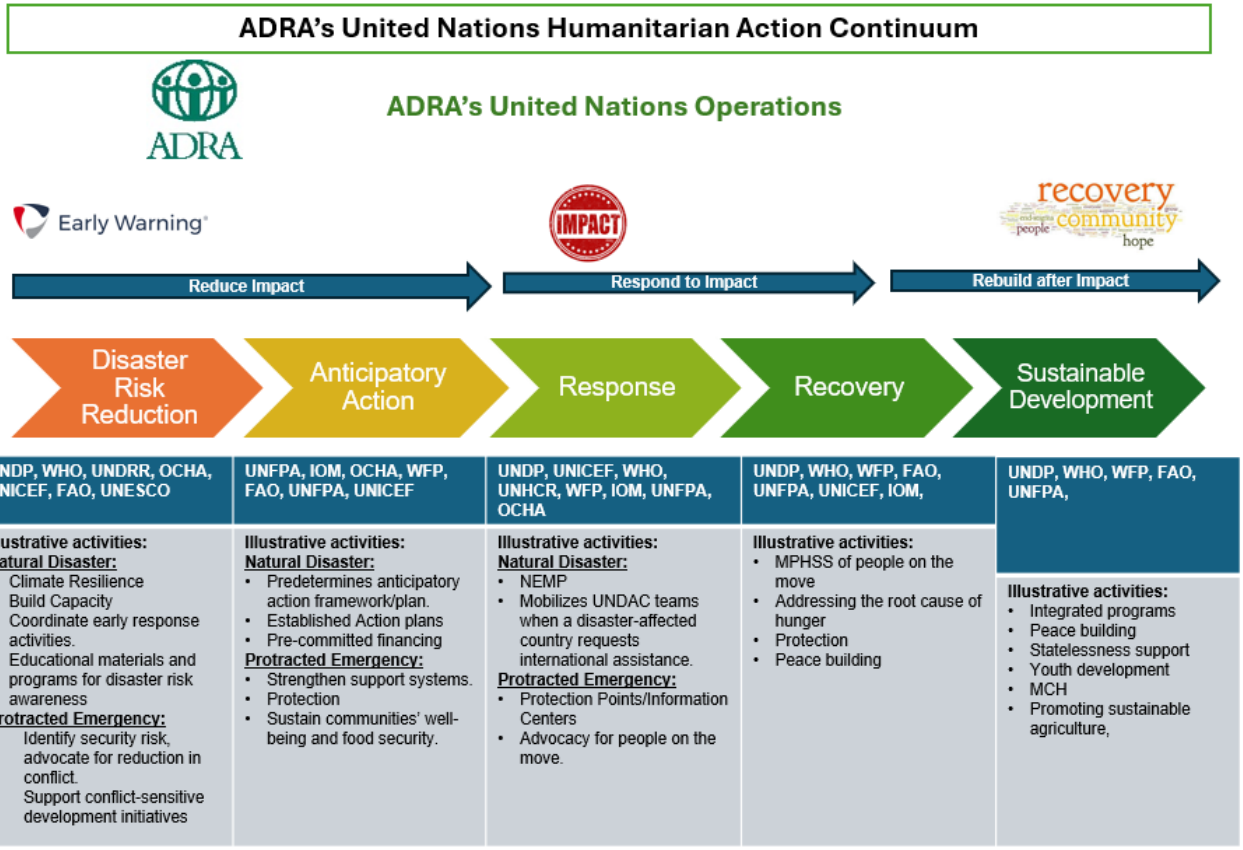
Step 3: Engage at Country Level

- Connect with UN Country Teams (UNCTs) through the UN Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (UNSDCF).
- Align NGO projects with national priorities and UNCT programming.

Step 4: Build Thematic Partnerships

- Identify agencies by sector:

- Education/Child Protection → UNICEF, UNESCO, UNHCR
- Health → WHO, UNFPA, UNAIDS
- Livelihoods/Employment → UNDP, ILO, FAO, UN Women
- Emergency Response → WFP, OCHA, UNHCR
- Environment/Climate → UNEP, FAO, UNDRR



Step 5: Participate in UN Platforms & Events

- Register on Indico.UN to attend conferences, workshops, and consultations.
- Use UN Women Training Centre and other agency portals for capacity building.
- Showcase initiatives on the SDG Partnership Platform.

Step 6: Strengthen Relationships & Visibility

- Network at UN conferences and side events.
- Publish joint advocacy materials with UN agencies.
- Demonstrate accountability and transparency to meet UN fiduciary standards.

Annex: Detailed agency profiles and offices

Headquarters in New York

Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA)

OCHA is mandated to mobilize and coordinate effective and principled humanitarian action in partnership with national and international actors to alleviate human suffering in disasters and emergencies; advocate for the rights of people in need; promote preparedness and prevention; and facilitate sustainable solutions.
https://www.unocha.org/

United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)

UNDP is the UN's global development network, connecting countries to knowledge, experience and resources to help people build a better life. The priority areas of focus of creating prosperity for everyone, strengthening how countries are governed, building crisis resilience and ensuring a healthy planet.
CSO engagement is founded on five principles and commitments: Partnership founded on horizontality (equality), trust, inclusion and mutual capability; Recognition of obligations as a duty-bearer; Negotiation and mutual agenda-setting with individual accountability; Desegregation, selection and intellectual differentiation; and Macro-micro coherence and balance: connecting upstream and downstream.
www.undp.org

Headquarters in Rome

Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)

The Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) leads international efforts to defeat hunger by helping developing countries and countries in transition to modernize and improve their agriculture, forestry and fisheries practices and to ensure food security for all. FAO's activities comprise four main areas: (i) providing technical advice and assistance; (ii) collecting, analyzing and disseminating information on food, nutrition, agriculture, fisheries and forestry; (iii) offering independent advice to governments on agricultural policy; and (iv) providing a neutral forum where governments, international organizations and NGOs can meet to discuss food and agricultural issues.
www.fao.org

International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)

IFAD is mandated to combat hunger and rural poverty in the low-income food-deficit regions of the world and to improve the livelihoods of rural poor people on a sustainable basis. IFAD works with a variety of NGOs. At the field level, it works with development NGOs that have the necessary expertise and direct outreach to rural poor populations. It also works with NGOs that may not work directly with the poor but support other grassroots organizations in a variety of ways,

such as research, technical assistance, capacity building, information sharing, advocacy and networking. In addition, the Fund works with advocacy NGOs that promote the cause of rural poverty reduction and have influence in the policy-making processes of governments and/or development agencies.
www.ifad.org

World Food Programme (WFP)

WFP is mandated to combat hunger, promote economic and social development and provide relief assistance in emergencies throughout the world. WFP is supporting efforts to strengthen civil society and further promote its role in food security as NGOs play a key role in both humanitarian emergencies and sustainable development. WFP works with civil society to reach vulnerable communities with the assistance they need.
www.wfp.org

Headquarters in Geneva

International Labour Organization (ILO)

(ILO) is the UN specialized agency promoting the global goal of Decent Work for women and men everywhere. Placing the Decent Work Agenda at the centre of national and international policies is essential in the fight against poverty and in promoting a fair globalization that creates opportunities for all. The ILO has a unique tripartite structure with workers and employers participating as equal partners with governments in the work of its governing organs. Due to this structure the ILO maintains a multifaceted relationship with the non-governmental sector, which involves the following: the integration of non-governmental social partners in the identity of the Organization itself; according consultative status to international NGOs that meet certain criteria; and collaboration at the operational level with a variety of international, national and local organizations.
www.ilo.org

Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR)

OHCHR's mission is to protect and promote human rights for all. OHCHR aims to ensure implementation of universally recognized human rights norms, strengthen the United Nations human rights programme, and provide the United Nations treaty monitoring bodies and special mechanisms established by the Commission on Human Rights with the highest support.
OHCHR has four main Branches to carry out its task: (i) The Treaties and Commission Branch services the Human Rights Treaty Bodies, the Commission on Human Rights and related working groups, the Sub-Commission on the Promotion and Protection of Human Rights and the United Nations Voluntary Fund for Victims of Torture; (ii) The Research and Right to Development Branch engages in research and has primary responsibility for the promotion and protection of the right to development; (iii) The Capacity Building and Field Operations Branch supports OHCHR's operations in the field, provides technical cooperation and advisory services to governments, National Human Rights Institutions and NGOs; and (iv) The Special Procedures Branch supports the activities of the special mechanisms of the Commission on Human Rights (known collectively

as the “special procedures”), which track and investigate specific types of systematic human rights violations.
www.ohchr.org

Joint United Nations Programme on HIV/AIDS (UNAIDS)

UNAIDS comprises ten cosponsoring agencies—the United Nations Children’s Fund (UNICEF), the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), the United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA), the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC), the International Labour Organization (ILO), the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO), the World Food Programme (WFP), the World Health Organization (WHO), the World Bank, and most recently the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR). UNAIDS is the leading advocate for worldwide action against HIV/AIDS. It promotes partnerships among and between a broad range of actors—including other UN agencies, governments, corporations, media, sports and religious organizations, community-based groups, regional and country networks of people living with HIV/AIDS (PLWHA), and civil society representatives—to mobilize an enhanced response to AIDS.
www.unaids.org

United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD)

UNCTAD promotes the development-friendly integration of developing countries into the world economy. The Organization aims to help shape current policy debates and thinking on development, with a particular focus on ensuring that domestic policies and international action are mutually supportive in bringing about sustainable development. UNCTAD is the principal organ of the General Assembly in the field of trade and development.
UNCTAD views NGOs and the private sector as full-fledged partners in its activities, allowing the Organization to have a better understanding of the concerns of members of civil society and to supply a better response to their specific needs and requirements. UNCTAD reaches out to non-governmental stakeholders in various ways, including through the dissemination of its work via a number of informal channels (using the networks of associated institutions and actors) and through informal meetings and dialogue.
www.unctad.org

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) – *HQ Geneva*

UNHCR is mandated to lead and coordinate international action to protect refugees and resolve refugee problems worldwide. Its primary purpose is to safeguard the rights and wellbeing of refugees. It strives to ensure that everyone can exercise the right to seek asylum and find safe refuge in another State, with the option to return home voluntarily, integrate locally or to resettle in a third country.
UNHCR partners with governments, intergovernmental and non-governmental organizations, and UN agencies to protect and assist refugees, leading to durable solutions. Two types of partnerships exist: (i) *Implementing partnerships* are those in which UNHCR provides financial support to an NGO to perform specific services to help refugees and is reflected in a formal project agreement. These partnerships are normally established in the area of operations and NGOs are selected on the basis of basic conditions and specific criteria. (ii) *Operational partnerships* involve the voluntary close coordination between UNHCR and NGOs in such areas as emergency relief and resettlement

and do not include financial support by UNHCR. Both these partnerships also work with UNHCR on advocacy activities, promoting refugee rights and State responsibility in refugee protection.
www.unhcr.org

The World Health Organization (WHO)

WHO aims for the attainment by all peoples of the highest possible level of health. The Organization's Constitution defines health as a state of complete physical, mental and social wellbeing and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity. In support of its objective, WHO has a wide range of functions, including acting as the directing and coordinating authority on international health work; establishing and maintaining effective collaboration with the UN specialized agencies, governmental health administrations, professional groups and other organizations as may be deemed appropriate; assisting governments to strengthen their health services; furnishing appropriate technical assistance and, in emergencies, necessary aid; and proposing conventions, agreements and regulations, as well as making recommendations with respect to international health matters. The Organization also promotes improved teaching and training standards in the health, medical and related professions, and develops international standards for food, biological, pharmaceutical and similar products.
www.who.int

The World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)

WIPO is dedicated to helping to ensure that the rights of creators and owners of intellectual property (IP) are protected worldwide and that inventors and authors are, thus, recognized and rewarded for their ingenuity. The intellectual property system offers a number of safeguards and incentives that act as a spur to human creativity, extending the boundaries of science and technology and enriching the world of literature and the arts. By providing a stable environment for the marketing of intellectual property products, it also helps to promote international trade. WIPO undertakes activities in three main areas, namely (i) the progressive development of international intellectual property law; (ii) assistance to developing countries to build intellectual property capacity at national and regional levels and encourage more effective use of IP as tool for economic development; and (iii) services to industry and the private sector to facilitate the process of obtaining intellectual property protection in multiple countries.
www.wipo.int

The World Meteorological Organization (WMO)

WMO is a specialized agency of the United Nations with the scientific voice on the state and behaviour of the earth's atmosphere, its interaction with the oceans, the climate and the resulting distribution of water resources. WMO facilitates worldwide cooperation in the establishment of network of stations and centres to provide meteorological and related services and observations; promotes the establishment and maintenance of systems for the rapid exchange of meteorological and related information; promotes standardization of meteorological and related observations and ensures the uniform publication of observations and statistics; furthers the application of meteorology to aviation, shipping, water problems, agriculture and other human activities; promotes activities in operational hydrology; and encourages research and training in meteorology and related fields.
https://wmo.int

Headquarters in Nairobi

United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

UNEP provides leadership and encourages partnership in caring for the environment by inspiring, informing and enabling nations and peoples to improve their quality of life without compromising that of future generations.

UNEP's work encompasses: Assessing global, regional and national environmental conditions and trends; Developing international and national environmental instruments; Strengthening institutions for the wise management of the environment; Facilitating the transfer of knowledge and technology for sustainable development; and Encouraging new partnerships and mind-sets within civil society and business and industry.

www.unep.org

United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA) (by end of 2026)

UNFPA extends assistance to developing countries, countries with economies in transition and other countries at their request to help them address reproductive health and population issues, and also works to raise awareness of these issues in all countries.

UNFPA's three main areas of work are: to help ensure universal access to reproductive health, including family planning and sexual health, to all couples and individuals on or before the year 2015; to support population and development strategies that enable capacity building in population programming; and to promote gender equality and women's empowerment by bringing gender issues to wider attention, promoting legal and policy reforms and gender-sensitive data collection, and supporting projects that empower women economically and politically.

www.unfpa.org

The United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) (by end of 2026)

UNICEF was created in 1946 to provide aid to European children affected by World War II. In 1953 it became a permanent part of the UN, and the UN General Assembly extended UNICEF's mandate indefinitely. UNICEF's work covers a wide range of child-related issues. Priorities include immunization, education, early childhood development, child protection, and HIV/AIDS.

UNICEF enters into various kinds of formal agreements depending on the nature of the collaboration. For instance, at the country level, it may sign a Project Cooperation Agreement with a community-based NGO. At the regional level, it may sign a Joint Programme of Work

www.unicef.org

UN Women *(by end of 2026)*

UN Women exists to advance women's rights, gender equality, and the empowerment of all women and girls. As the lead United Nations entity on gender equality and secretariat of the UN Commission on the Status of Women, UN Women shift laws, institutions, social norms, and services to close the gender gap and build an equal world for all women and girls.

UN Women's partnership with civil society has been strategic and innovative and aimed at strengthening political solidarity and feminist movement building. Continued partnership with grass-roots women and youth has fostered their ongoing dialogue with key policymakers, ensuring that their voices are not left out of these crucial processes.
www.unwomen.org

The United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-HABITAT)

UN-HABITAT promotes socially and environmentally sustainable human settlements development and the achievement of adequate shelter for all. It is the lead agency within the UN system for coordinating activities in the field of cities and other human settlements. As towns and cities grow at unprecedented rates setting the social, political, cultural and environmental trends of the world, sustainable urbanization is one of the most pressing challenges facing the global community in the 21st century.
In its work to improve human settlements, reduce poverty and increase safety in towns and cities as well as making them more sustainable and environmentally friendly, UN-HABITAT has found it essential to work with a wide range of partners.
https://unhabitat.org/

Headquarters in Paris

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

UNESCO is mandated to contribute to peace and security by promoting collaboration among nations through education, science and culture in order to further universal respect for justice, for the rule of law and for the human rights and fundamental freedoms which are affirmed for the peoples of the world, without distinction of race, sex, language or religion, by the Charter of the United Nations.
www.unesco.org

Headquarters in Vienna

United Nations Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO)

UNIDO's mandate is to act as the central coordinating body for industrial activities within the UN system and to promote industrial development, focuses its efforts on relieving poverty by fostering productivity growth. It helps developing countries and countries with economies in transition in their fight against marginalization by mobilizing knowledge, skills, information and technology to promote productive employment, competitive economy and sound environment.
UNIDO cooperates with CSOs within the fields of agro-industry, cluster development, rural and women entrepreneurs, productive work for youth, micro small- and medium-sized enterprise (MSME) development, investment promotion and transfer of technology, quality and standardization, renewable energy and environment. UNIDO aims to further increase its cooperation with CSOs as they represent and provide services to individuals as well as to all types of enterprises, ranging from the macro- to the micro-level, both in the formal and informal sectors.
www.unido.org

The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC)

UNODC is mandated to assist Member States in their struggle against illicit drugs, crime and terrorism. UNODC focus on and enhance its capacity to address the interrelated issues of drug control, crime prevention and international terrorism in all its forms. The three pillars of UNODC's work programme are: (i) research and analytical work to increase knowledge and understanding of drugs and crime issues and expand the evidence-base for policy and operational decisions; (ii) normative work to assist States in the ratification and implementation of the international treaties, the development of domestic legislation on drugs, crime and terrorism, and the provision of secretariat and substantive services to the treaty-based and governing bodies; and (iii) field-based technical cooperation projects to enhance the capacity of Member States to counteract illicit drugs, crime and terrorism.

www.unodc.org

Headquarters in Washington DC

The World Bank Group

The World Bank assists developing countries to reduce poverty by helping them raise their levels of productivity and income, by providing loans and grants to low- and middle-income countries, as well as policy advice, technical assistance and knowledge-sharing services.

The Bank's mandate includes a group of five closely associated institutions—the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), the International Development Association (IDA), the International Finance Corporation (IFC), the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) and the International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID). Each institution plays a distinct role in the Bank's mission: the IBRD and the IDA provide loans and grants to low and middle income countries; the IFC promotes economic development through the private sector; MIGA helps promote foreign direct investment by providing guarantees to investors against non-commercial risks; and the ICSID offers international facilities for conciliation and arbitration of investment disputes to help build mutual confidence between States and foreign investors.

The World Bank engages CSOs in three ways.

- Facilitating dialogue and partnership between civil society and governments by providing resources, training, technical support, and often playing a convening role. That type of engagement can be best seen in the process of formulation of the country poverty reduction strategies (PRSPs);
- Consulting with CSOs on issues, policies and programmes by listening to their perspectives and inviting suggestions. These interactions vary from consultations on global policies such as social safeguards and adjustment lending, to discussions on local Bank-financed projects; and,
- Partnering directly with CSOs through contracting technical assistance and training services, funding civil society initiatives, and managing joint programmes. There are many examples of active partnerships in the areas of forest conservation, AIDS vaccines, rural poverty, micro-credit, and Internet development

https://www.worldbank.org

Headquarters in Copenhagen

The United Nations Office for Project Services (UNOPS)

Unlike other members of the UN family with mandates in policy and programming, UNOPS is the only member of the UN family that is fully dedicated to implementation. UNOPS is a central resource for project services as a key operational arm of the UN system, enabling the work of the UN, international financial institutions, governments and other partners by providing critical operational and logistical support to UN missions and humanitarian action operations.
https://www.unops.org/